



Photo Courtesy: Tonya Patterson

Fall Is Sizzling (and So Is the Chili!)

Fall is here, and the Hayride, Trunk-or-Treat, and Chili & Soup Cook-Off is **Saturday, October 10** at the Boat Launch. Grab a costume, bring your appetite (and some cash for People's Choice votes and raffles), and read on for the full rundown. Plus: a look back at the Sub Crawl, fish stocking news, and what the board has been working on.

You Need to Know

Sheriff

989-539-7166

Fire Department

989-539-7145

Oxygen

Mary Ann Wood
10385 N. Athey Ave.
989-274-4315

Frank DeVuono
9982 South Shore
586-482-0907

Emergency walkie-talkies, oxygen and AED

Charlie and Deb Smith
9895 Toohy Trail
989-560-5811
989-424-8633

COMMUNITY NEWS

2026 Dates to Remember

- **Friday, October 9**
 - House & yard decorating contest judging, Dusk
- **Saturday, October 10**
 - ELCOA board meeting, 10:00 AM
 - Chili & Soup Cook-Off judging, 12:30 PM
 - Hayride, Trunk-or-Treat & Chili/Soup Cook-Off, 1:00 PM
 - Costume contest, 2:00 PM
 - Trunk-or-Treat, 3:00 PM
 - Piñata, cupcake decorating & pumpkin painting, 4:00 PM

October 10: Hayride & Chili/Soup Cook-Off

This year's headline event is **Saturday, October 10 at the Boat Launch**. Cook-off judging starts at 12:30 PM (judges only), and everyone is welcome from 1:00 PM. Here's the full day:

- **1:00 PM:** Hot dogs, soup, and chili are ready. Trick-or-treat bags provided to kids while supplies last.
 - **2:00 PM:** Costume contest, judged in four age brackets: 0-4, 5-12, 13-17, and 18+. Prizes for each category.
 - **3:00 PM:** Trunk-or-Treat. Decorate your vehicle for a shot at a prize, and bring candy to pass. Organizers are expecting 100+ kids if the weather cooperates.
 - **4:00 PM:** Piñata, cupcake decorating, and pumpkin & gourd painting.
 - **Hayrides to follow**, with multiple rides provided.
- Chili & Soup Cook-Off:** neighbors' chili and soup go head to head, with 1st-, 2nd-, and 3rd-place ribbons in each category plus ribbons for best-decorated table. The **People's Choice Trophy** goes to whichever pot raises the most cash in votes, so bring bills to support your favorite. Cash prizes are bigger this year.

Cornhole tournament: it's on for cook-off day, and the trophies have been engraved and upgraded. Watch the Facebook group for sign-up details.

House & yard decorating contest: judging is **Friday, October 9**. No need to sign up; judges simply drive every road at dusk. Show off your spookiest or most creative decorating!

New this year: a hot chocolate station to warm up with between activities. Bring cash for raffles throughout the day.

Thank you, helpers: Mark Scott is bringing his wagon (now on new tires), and the Wright family is providing the tractor. If you can lend a hand with the grill, the fire pit, or the piñata, or sponsor a raffle basket, reach out through the Facebook group or contact@elcoa.org.

This year's Hayride is supported by Hunter's Paradise, Action Asphalt, AKA Electric, and On the Level Concrete Raising. Thank you for helping make it happen!

Fish order is in

Frank DeVuono has placed a \$1,900 order for this fall's fish planting. Fish go in once the water cools to about 55°F. The last stocking, in fall 2024, added nearly 1,000 crappie and walleye. Fish Fund donations are always welcome on your membership form.

Lake water still testing excellent

The lake was tested again this summer, and the results were the same as 2025: excellent, and far below the level that would be a concern for swimming. Thank you to Charlie Smith for handling the water testing.

Beach and boat launch projects

Kendra Koman is leading improvements at the beach. The neighbors on both sides have okayed tree trimming and a privacy fence, and RJ has volunteered to trim the trees. The play structure has reached the end of its life, so ELCOA is looking for a new swing set: if you spot a good deal on Facebook Marketplace or an end-of-season sale, let Kendra know. Plans also include a snow fence, a new display board, and an enclosure for the porta john.

The beach and boat launch could also use new picnic tables, and a second message board to replace one lost to a fallen tree. This could be a great winter build project if a few volunteers step up. Interested? Reach out through the Facebook group or contact@elcoa.org.

Boat Parade chair needed

The Fourth of July Boat Parade needs a chairperson for next summer. If you'd like to lead one of the lake's favorite traditions, let the board know at contact@elcoa.org.

From the September 5 board meeting

- **Treasurer's report:** starting balance of \$7,476.01 as of August 2, with an available balance of \$5,323.63 after expenses.
- **Membership:** 73 members and counting. Dues are still coming in, and Deb Smith is giving new residents a welcome letter and a copy of the latest newsletter.
- **Fish planting:** Frank DeVuono placed a \$1,900 order for this fall.
- **Porta johns:** the board approved having porta johns from May through October.
- **Boat launch light:** it costs about \$312 a year, mostly administrative fees. The board is weighing a motion-activated light or an outlet with a lock box, and Tonya Patterson is looking into options.

- **Equipment:** the cornhole trophies have been engraved and upgraded, and the board is interested in buying a newer tent that's quicker to set up.
- **Looking ahead:** Cassie Kelly will chair the 2027 Memorial Day Parade, and the Boat Parade still needs a chair.

From the August 2 board meeting

- **Treasurer's report:** starting balance of \$6,531.97, available balance of \$5,446.01 after expenses and income. The fish fund allotment was corrected to \$1,000 (not \$500); the fish fund itself stood at \$1,900, not counting donations.
- **Membership:** 9 new memberships brought the total to 59. The board discussed reviving the Welcome Package for new residents and possibly bringing back street captains to help distribute it.
- **Boat Parade winners:** Neighbor's (1st), Miller's (2nd), Beck's (3rd), Logan's (4th), with cash prizes of \$25, \$20, \$15, and \$10.
- **Hayride budget:** the board approved a one-time \$200 transfer from the unused Memorial Day Parade budget to help cover this year's Hayride/Chili Cook-Off.
- **New board members:** the board welcomed six new members: Erie High, Cassie Kelly, Angela Kraetke, Deb Smith, Lucky Mottausch, and Mary Ann Wood.

Join the Chatter

Elbow Lake Chatter is the official voice of ELCOA. Send local news, comments, ideas, or photos to contact@elcoa.org.

ELCOA has a new website: elcoa.org. Read this issue online, browse every past newsletter back to 2019, and check upcoming events.

ACTIVITIES

Sub Crawl recap

What a turnout! On September 5, neighbors fired up their golf carts and side-by-sides for the progressive Sub Crawl: six host houses, games and a signature drink or cocktail at every stop, and live music from Blake James Music at the Boat Launch to close out the night. Thank you to every host house and everyone who came out to make it a great one.







SUMMARY OF MINUTES FROM ELCOA BOARD OF DIRECTORS MEETING

ELCOA Meeting Minutes from Sunday, August 2, 2026

Location: Boat Launch

Present: Mark Scott, Donnie & Tonya Patterson, Jonathan Kelly, Sally Rouse, Eric Rouse, Marty Neighbors, John Krieger, Frank DeVuono, John Collins, Lisa Wick, Tyler Hay, Kendra Koman, Scott Cupp

Absent: None

Guests: Angela Kraetke, Cassie Kelly, Mary Ann Wood, Deb Smith, Charlie Smith, Lucky Mottausch, Erie High

The meeting was called to order at 10:01 a.m. by President Mark Scott.

Minutes: Sally Rouse read the minutes from Saturday, July 4, 2026. A motion was made to approve as is by John Collins and seconded by John Krieger. Motion passed.

Treasurer's Report: The financial report was read by John Kelly, noting a starting balance of \$6,531.97 with expenses and new income resulting in an available balance of \$5,446.01. It was noted that the fish fund allotment should be \$1,000.00, not \$500.00, on the report. The current total for fish is \$1,900 as of this meeting (not including donations).

Membership Report: Tonya indicated there were 9 new memberships submitted and a total of 59 members as of today. A discussion took place on how to grow membership. It was mentioned to bring back the Welcome Package. Deb Smith is willing to do this, but she needs to know how to get new residents' info. It was suggested to contact Clare County and purchase the tax roll for \$10.00. It was also mentioned to bring back street captains, put welcome info in the newsletters, and provide packets inside the bulletin board. More discussion at the next meeting.

Neighborhood Watch: Frank indicated there was a big explosion the night before. It sounded like an M-80. Many members heard the noise, but no one knows exactly where it came from.

Facebook/Website: No updates on the website or Facebook. It was mentioned that Tyler did a fantastic job on the newsletter.

Memorial Day Parade: Cassie Kelly has volunteered to chair the Memorial Day Parade for 2027.

Boat Parade: Shirley Miller submitted the scoring sheet for the previous day's parade. Winners: Neighbor's 1st, Miller's 2nd, Beck's 3rd, Logan's 4th. Cash prizes of \$25, \$20, \$15, and \$10 respectively were awarded.

Annual Picnic: Kendra has everything ready to go for today's event.

Hay Ride: Sally and Tonya to chair the hayride/chili cook-off. Folks will be encouraged to bring a dish to pass. Hot dogs and pop will be provided. A hot chocolate station will be included this year. Times have yet to be determined. Tonya would like to have the house decorating contest again this year. Judging of the winners will take place on Friday, October 9th. A tractor and trailer are needed for the event. Mark is hoping his truck will be ready so he can transport the wagon up north. Kendra made a motion to allow a one-time transfer of \$200.00 from the Memorial Day Parade budget to the Hayride/Chili Cook-Off for 2026, since the Memorial Day Parade does not spend its allotted amount. Sally seconded. Motion passed.

Beach Beautification: Nothing new to report.

Fish Planting: Frank is going to call this week to get pricing information.

Old Business: Discussion about the illegal dumping of wood at the boat launch wooded area was brought up again. There was a suggestion to use a woodchipper and blow the chips into the woods.

New Business: The cornhole trophies have run out of room for new winners; more rings are needed, and Marty will handle it. Mark brought up that there is room on the board for more members. Nominations were made to add the following individuals to the board: Erie High, Cassie Kelly, Angela Kraetke, Deb Smith, Lucky Mottausch, Mary Ann Wood. Mark asked each individual if they would accept the position. All agreed and accepted.

A motion was made to adjourn at 10:57 a.m. by Kendra. Seconded by Tyler. Motion passed.

Respectfully submitted by Sally Rouse, Secretary for ELCOA.

ELCOA Board Meeting Minutes from Saturday, September 5, 2026

Location: Boat Launch

Present: Mark Scott, Donnie & Tonya Patterson, Jonathan Kelly, Sally Rouse, Eric Rouse, Marty Neighbors, John Krieger, Frank DeVuono, John Collins, Kendra Koman, Angela Kraetke, Deb Smith, Scott Cupp

Absent: Lisa Wick, Tyler Hay, Erie High, Mary Ann Wood, Lucky Mottausch.

Guest: None.

The meeting was called to order at 10:02 a.m. by President Mark Scott.

Minutes: Sally Rouse read the minutes from Sunday, August 2, 2026. A motion was made to approve as is by John Collins and seconded by Donnie. Motion passed.

Treasurer's Report: The financial report was read by John Kelly noting a starting balance of \$7,476.01 as of 8/2/26 with an available balance of \$5,323.63 after expenses.

Membership Report: Tonya indicated there are a total of 73 members as of today. Membership fees have been slowly coming in. Kevin and Tammy Brady have rejoined the association. Deb Smith indicated that Mary Ann did not get the roll call list from the county. Deb Smith gave 2 newsletters to the new folks in the association. Deb has a welcome letter and provides a copy of the recent newsletter.

Neighborhood Watch: Frank indicated that there was nothing to report at this time.

Facebook/Website: Tyler was absent, nothing was reported.

Memorial Day Parade: Cassie Kelly has volunteered to chair the Memorial Day Parade for 2027.

Boat Parade: No discussion. Chairperson still needed for this event.

Annual Picnic: No discussion.

Hay Ride: Mark Scott will bring up his wagon and it has new tires. Frank will talk to Love at Hunter's Paradise to see if they plan on sponsoring the event. Sally spoke to the Wright's and they plan on providing the tractor for the hayride.

Beach Beautification: Kendra reported that both property owners next to the beach are ok with the tree trimming and putting up a privacy fence. RJ volunteered to trim trees on both sides. Kendra said the play structure has met its life expectancy and a new swing set is needed. She asked the board to watch on Facebook, marketplace or end of season deals and to let her know. She would like to put up a snow fence, a new display board and would like to build an enclosure for the porta john.

Fish Planting: Frank called and put in an order for 1900 fish. Ideally, it would be nice to get some photos or video of the fish being dropped. Tyler will be asked to be present if able.

Old Business: It's possible that Ed Erskine and Caleb Stenger may take care of the illegal dumping at the boat launch area. Marty informed the board the boat launches light costs about \$26.00 a month, but the majority of the cost is the administrative fees, it's \$312.00 a year to have. A discussion took place about having a motion activated light or having a drop with plug to get electricity with a lock box. Tonya will look into it.

New Business: The trophies for the cornhole tournament have been engraved and upgraded. Donnie will talk to his friend to see if he has any more tents to sale, the board is interested in purchasing a newer one that will take less time to assemble. A motion was made to have porta johns from May to October, all were in favor. Motion passed.

A motion was made to adjourn at 10:56 a.m. by Kendra. Seconded by Donnie. Motion passed.

Respectfully submitted by Sally Rouse, Secretary for ELCOA.

CONTACT INFORMATION FOR 2026-2027

ELCOA OFFICERS	President Mark Scott	586-496-3800	mascott7676@gmail.com
	Vice President Donnie Patterson	517-375-2500	dpatterson@ditchwitchmi.com
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	Frank DeVuono	586-940-9958	fjdevuono@gmail.com
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	Community Support Person Blaire Embrey		blaireembrey@gmail.com
	Annual Picnic Mary Ann Wood	989-274-4315	woodmaryann46@gmail.com
	Shirley Miller	586-764-3257	millershirley36@gmail.com
	Hayride Sally Rouse	586-709-0401	sallykaufman2005@yahoo.com
	Tonya Patterson	517-219-3121	tonyacunnings15@gmail.com
	Facebook Administrator Rick Elenbaas	989-890-1700	relenbaas198523@gmail.com
	Newsletter/Website Tyler Hay	269-303-5906	contact@elcoa.org
	Water Testing Charlie Smith	989-424-8633	kai538@yahoo.com
	Facebook Administrator Mark Scott	586-496-3800	mascott7676@gmail.com
	Lake Weeds Treatment Mary Ann Wood	989-274-4315	woodmaryann46@gmail.com
	Fish Planting/Neighborhood Watch Frank DeVuono	586-482-0907	fjdevuono@gmail.com
	Beach Beautification Kendra Koman		
	Memorial Day Parade (2027) Cassie Kelly		ckelly6053@gmail.com
	Boat Parade Chair needed		